Critical Incident Comms Training

Identifying and dealing with critical incidents comms. Get organised.

PARTICIPANTS

Welcome to the CIN Training Overview!

We are genuinely excited to welcome each and every one of you to the digitally run Critical Incident Communications Training.

This overview document gives you some **background and context to the programme**. It explains how the training is designed and why.

Just **use the navigation to the right** to zoom in and out of this overview, and we'll see you soon!

Training Goal

To increase Greenpeace's organisational and communication responsiveness by building confidence, team cohesion and staff capacity in how to identify and deal with critical incidents communication (particularly as a part of a Critical Incident response team).

4 weeks | 20 - 25 people | Beginner

Meet the team

Your friendly core team has crafted this learning experience for you, but we couldn't run it alone! We are pleased to be supported by all of the CIN and especially our colleagues who are serving as trainers in the experience.

Elizabeth Godwin
Elizabeth manages staff-focused training, learning, and development programs. She brings 10 years of experience in learning design.

Patric Salize
Patric is the project sponsor and subject matter expert for the CIN training. He's worked with critical incident management teams for decades.

Laura Hilliger
Laura is a concept architect who brings over a decade of learning theory and design in online and blended learning environments. Laura is supported by colleagues at We Are Open Co-op.

CIN Trainings: Building a Community of Practice

We need ***capable, thoughtful comms professionals...***

A strong international network, able to:
- monitor, analyse, handle, and escalate critical issues relevant to Greenpeace as an organization
- lead or support communication in international critical incident situations

At the end of the training, you will have:
- a comprehensive set of knowledge about the mechanics of scandals and crises as well as of the organisational fondations, to tackle communications during critical incidents
- a common understanding of what constitutes a critical incident, an issue or a crisis
- a good self-understanding and know how they react to stress

This training aims to build trust among the participants.

This is important to build the necessary network to discuss critical incidents and issues in the network. The training contents is also meant to mark a starting point for a discussion around the organisational approach to deal with critical issues and incidents; to expand our definition to include responsiveness. As a network, we will be able to communicate effectively about regional and global issues.

Learning Objectives

We are running the CIN Communication Training to increase Greenpeace's organisational and communication responsiveness by building confidence, team cohesion and staff capacity in how to identify and deal with critical incidents communication (particularly as a part of a Critical Incident response team).

To that end we have 5 overarching objectives that are the basis of this training:

- **Shared understanding** - building a shared vocabulary and mental model for critical incidents to apply the appropriate tactics and techniques for critical incidents communications
- **Decision-making** - identifying relevant information, making a judgement, and choosing a path forward
- **Collaboration under pressure** - supporting other individuals and the team to respond effectively in difficult and stressful situations
- **Stress resilience** - developing self-awareness to understand capacity and desire for dealing with difficult and stressful situations
- **Conflict reframing** - articulating risks to identify communication opportunities

How will we learn together?

The Structure

The Critical Incident training takes place over a period of four weeks and includes a **range of approaches** from self study, through to working in small teams and role play.

The training programme is designed to **escalate from Week 2** into a peak at the end of Week 3. In addition, each scenario involves escalations which each team involved in the training will have to choose how to manage.

Your team

You will be on a **5-6 person team** with participants fulfilling various communications roles- such as comms lead, digital lead, press officer, internal comms, GPI hubs editor/media. The remaining CIMT roles will be enacted through a combination of asynchronous training materials, as well as the trainers and CIN community members.

Trainer Committee

A trainer is embedded in each team to help guide them, and provide an overview to the Trainer Committee, the facilitator or group of facilitators coordinating the training.

Roles on the TC:

- **Lead trainer** runs the training sessions for their dedicated group of trainees.
- **Co-Trainers** are confident trainers that support the lead trainer in facilitating the scenario sessions.
- **Subject matter expert** is experienced in scenario based training and can advise other trainers on how to conduct scenario based training best.
- **Training Coordinators** The coordinator(s) ensure that the training works across focus teams and inline with pace and content.

Roles not in every session:

- **Tech Lead** keeps a close loop to the lead trainer as well as all involved and handles all technical channels being used.
- **Shadow Trainer** have the main objectives to learn and to support.

Where does the training happen?

- Greenpeace Academy (self-study materials)
- Slack (primary communication from trainers)
- Google Drive (training materials)
- Zoom (synchronous meetings)
- Email (general announcements)
- Note: messages you receive via other channels should not be considered to be part of the training programme.

Part of the stressors that the training will place upon participants include placing demands upon time, emotional resilience, and communication strategies. At all times, Greenpeace trainers will provide 'escape hatches' which allow participants to open a safety valve and decompress, should they need to.

The story so far...

2017
We started the "Critical Incident Communication Network" in 2017 to get better prepared "when the sh** hits the fan".

End of 2020
In response to the pandemic, GPI decides to make the CIN training 100% virtual.

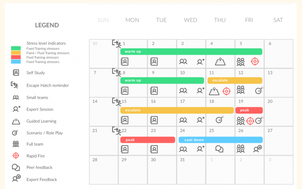
2021
A small team dreamed up big ideas on how the previously 100% in-person training could achieve the same *vibe* in an online environment. Then they created content, tested ideas and otherwise worked with CIN members to get feedback and insight.

End of 2021
In November/December 2021, the team ran an extensive pilot of the programme with the entire GPI Story & Communications team. This pilot included a rigorous evaluation, which the team has used to create the training before you now.

Now
From top to bottom, left to right, the Critical Incident Communication Training has been given the love and attention needed to ensure that our organisational and communication responsiveness to identify and deal with critical incidents communication is best in class.

What does the training month look like?

CIN training is designed to increase in intensity over the first 3 weeks, before easing off in the final week to allow for some reflection and cool down. There is a mix of guided learning, self-study, scenario response, and peer learning.



Weekly structure

Each week, participants will have one module of online learning to complete. This content is designed to introduce concepts and best practices from within Greenpeace. It is self-paced, so the participant determines how much time they devote to this work.

Synchronous sessions are held on Wednesdays, Thursdays and Fridays. Sessions take place in Zoom and Slack, and they are scheduled with the entire training cohort in mind. You will receive calendar invites for your team's sessions.

Hours per day

M	Self Study	1-2
T	Self Study	1-2
W	Small Teams Expert Sessions	2-3
Th	Guided Learning Scenario / Role Play	2-3
F	Scenario / Role Play Full team	4
Total		10 - 14

Links
Self Study Module

Prep Week: Setting the Scene

Main objective: We begin with metacognition, or 'thinking about thinking'. What's the link between thinking and behavior? What role does personality play in conflict? How can we develop a better mindset to deal with critical incidents? What stresses will this course put me under?

Focus of the week: Preparing for the coming weeks, and doing some self-study.

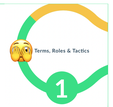
What's tricky: Finding time to complete the self-study and getting to know one another.

Week 1: Terms, Roles & Tactics

Main objective: This week is about developing our shared understanding and sharpening our decision making skills. What is the difference between a critical incident and a crisis? What is an issue? What does risk mean in our context? Who is responsible during a critical incident and what are best practices in communication in these situations?

Focus of the week: Coming together as a team working to respond to a communication crisis.

What's tricky: People respond differently in crisis situations! How will our personalities show up this week?



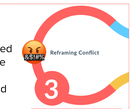
LINKS
MONDAY & TUESDAY
Self Study Module
WEDNESDAY
Expert session
Small team
THURSDAY
Guided Learning
FRIDAY
Rapid Fires
Weekly Debrief
Weekly Assessment

Week 3: Reframing Conflict

Main objective: In week 3 the heat is turned way up, and you will use everything you've learned to respond to scenarios that will challenge you to think quickly, make sound decisions and take smart risks.

Focus of the week: Responding as quickly as possible to critical incidents, as well as seeing opportunities and being prepared before an issue becomes a critical incident.

What's tricky: Thinking deeply about potential risks would be easy if we weren't under time pressure or if we had a crystal ball. Will you be able to reframe situations, protect people involved and communicate well?



LINKS
MONDAY & TUESDAY
Self Study Module
WEDNESDAY
Expert session
Small team
THURSDAY
Role Play
FRIDAY
Scenario
Weekly Debrief
Weekly Assessment

LINKS
MONDAY & TUESDAY
Self Study Module
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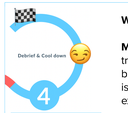
THURSDAY
Guided Learning
FRIDAY
Role Play
Weekly Debrief
Weekly Assessment

Week 2: Comms & Collaboration in a Crisis

Main objective: We will continue to develop our decision making skills and shared understanding of crisis communication. In addition, we will focus on dealing with the social, cultural and other dynamics of crisis incidents. How do we deal with internal and external communication? How do we collaborate in these times?

Focus of the week: Making good decisions in communication, both internal and external and being observant of people around you.

What's tricky: Communication can be complex, with disinformation, trolls, negativity and political nonsense. Can you keep your cool and work collaboratively?



LINKS
MONDAY & TUESDAY
Self Study Module
WEDNESDAY
Expert session
Small team
THURSDAY
Reflection
Peer Feedback
FRIDAY
Final Debrief
Post Assessment

Week 4: Debrief & Cool down

Main objective: The CIN Communication training is designed to stress you out a little bit. We deal with tough situations, so week 4 is all about debriefing and reflecting on the experience.

Focus of the week: Reflecting and identifying the primary stressors you experienced during scenarios. You'll explore your experience and come up with some proactive strategies for yourself and your team.

What's tricky: Developing self-awareness is a lifelong endeavour anyway. To understand your own capacity and desire for dealing with difficult and stressful situations is part of what this training is all about!

Thank you!

This is **Version 0.1** of the CIN Communications Training Overview Mural

We are always looking for feedback, so please feel free to get in touch:

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